THE UNIVERSITY OF SYDNEY

Governance & Proposal

Alignment check of my AW3 – Governance & Proposal against the team anchor (Project ATLAS). IDs match 'AW3 & AW8 - Alignment review (changes needed).pdf'.

Red conflicts with the team's story or facts – rewrite or remove

Yellow right idea, but names, numbers, owners or wording must change

No highlight consistent with the team version – can stay

Overview of Governance

Organisational structure of the company

> ▲ **A3-02 (Minor):** Same structure as the team. Change 'five functions' to six and 'two steps' to 'at most three management levels' to match the team org chart.

An organisational structure defines how tasks, authority and reporting lines are distributed across an organisation (The University of Sydney, 2026). Four common types exist (Mintzberg, 1979):

- **Functional** – staff are grouped by specialism (e.g., Engineering, Sales). Roles are clear, but silos can form.
- **Hierarchical** – many layers and a clear chain of command. Stable and accountable, but slow to decide.
- **Flat** – few or no middle managers. Fast and innovative, but roles blur as headcount grows.
- **Matrix** – staff report to a functional manager and a project manager. Strong collaboration, but dual authority can confuse priorities.

Lyra uses a **flat, functional–matrix hybrid**. With 34 staff, no employee is more than two steps from the CEO (Figure 1). Every employee belongs to one of five functions, which own hiring, standards and professional development. Day-to-day work, however, happens in cross-functional product squads; for example, the Retrieval Quality squad combines machine learning engineers, a learning designer and a customer success contact. This matches the culture described in *About the Organisation*, where engineers, learning designers and former academics sit in the same squads.

The flat layer keeps decisions fast, which a one-year-old company needs, while the matrix element prevents a silo between engineering and pedagogy that would weaken a curriculum-grounded product. The known weakness of a matrix,

competing priorities, is managed by the executive team setting one ranked list of squad priorities each quarter.

Strategic decision making

> ▲ **A3-03 (Major):** Add the May planning cycle, Board reserved matters (over AUD 250,000; Severe risks). Replace table rows with the team's BMC decisions (margin, single provider, prove grounding, pricing model).

Lyra allocates decision rights across three tiers (Weill & Ross, 2004). The **Board** approves decisions that change the company's capital or risk position, such as the annual budget, fundraising and risk appetite for student data and AI. The **executive team** turns strategy into quarterly objectives linked to the FY2027 targets of eight university-wide licences, 90% renewal and gross margin above 70%. **Squads** make delivery decisions within that plan, and product claims are settled by evaluation data rather than opinion. Table 1 lists the strategic decisions raised by Lyra's Business Model Canvas (BMC).

Table 1. Strategic decisions drawn from the Business Model Canvas

BMC block	Strategic decision	Decided by
Customer Segments	When to expand beyond NSW pilots to Victoria, Queensland and TAFE	Board
Revenue Streams	EFTSL price bands and which premium modules to charge for	Executive; Board approves
Key Partnerships	How many model providers to use, and on what terms	Executive (CTO)
Cost Structure	Maximum inference cost per EFTSL that still protects a 70% margin	Board sets target; Executive manages
Customer Relationships	How to prove learning impact so that pilots convert and licences renew	Executive (Head of Growth)

The last decision is currently the most urgent and is the focus of this proposal.

Organisation chart

> ▲ **A3-04 (Critical):** Board must be five directors (Prof. Margaret Ellis, Dr Priya Raman, Daniel Whitford, J. Holloway, Fiona McKenzie) with the Audit, Risk & Compliance Committee.
>
> ▲ **A3-05 (Critical):** Figure 1 must be replaced: six executives (CTO 18, CPO 5, COO/CFO 2, Head of Security, Privacy & Compliance 2, Head of Sales & Partnerships 3, Head of Customer Success 3).

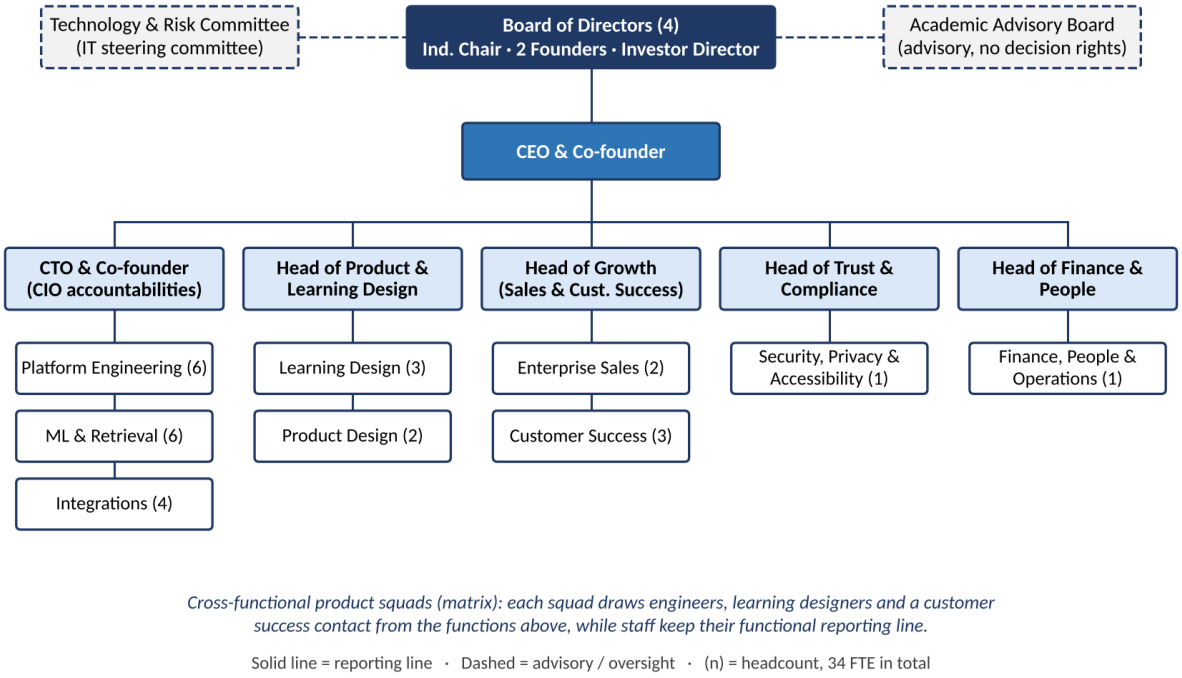


Figure 1. Organisation chart – Lyra Learning Pty Ltd

As a seed-funded proprietary company, Lyra is governed by a four-person **Board of Directors**: an independent chair with higher-education experience, the two founders (CEO and CTO) and a director nominated by the seed investor. The *Corporations Act 2001* (Cth) requires a proprietary company to have only one director; Lyra goes further so that an independent voice and investor oversight balance the founders.

The **CEO** reports to the Board and leads five heads, who each report directly to the CEO:

- **CTO** – platform, machine learning and integration engineering (16 staff) and the company's CIO duties.
- **Head of Product & Learning Design** – roadmap, user experience and pedagogy (5 staff).
- **Head of Growth** – enterprise sales and customer success (5 staff).
- **Head of Trust & Compliance** – security, privacy, accessibility and ISO 27001 (1 staff).
- **Head of Finance & People** – finance, HR, legal and operations (1 staff).

Two bodies sit outside the reporting lines (dashed in Figure 1). The **Academic Advisory Board** advises on pedagogy and the roadmap but has no decision rights. The **Technology & Risk Committee** oversees IT and data risk on behalf of the Board, as explained below.

IT in the Governance structure

> ▲ **A3-06 (Major):** Keep 'CTO holds CIO accountabilities'. Rename to Technology & AI Steering Committee, fix members, add the AI Quality & Ethics Review Board (CPO chair) and cite NAIC (2025).

Because Lyra's product is software, IT is not a support function but a strategic enabler at the centre of the business model (The University of Sydney, 2026). Lyra has no separate CIO; instead, the **CTO holds CIO accountabilities** for both the product platform and internal IT such as identity, devices and SaaS tools.

To stop the CTO from approving their own work, IT decisions are overseen by a **Technology & Risk Committee**, which acts as Lyra's IT steering committee. It is chaired by the CEO, meets monthly and includes the CTO, Head of Product & Learning Design, Head of Growth and Head of Trust & Compliance. It ranks IT investments against business objectives, approves major architecture and model-provider changes, and reviews security, privacy and AI-quality risks. It reports quarterly to the Board, which keeps final accountability for IT through the *evaluate–direct–monitor* model of ISO/IEC 38500 (International Organization for Standardization [ISO], 2024). The Head of Trust & Compliance, as Privacy Officer, gives an independent check on engineering. AW7 develops this structure in detail.

Roles and Responsibilities

> ▲ **A3-07 (Critical):** All names must follow the team roster (see review, Table 4). Several of my names are used by the team for different people.

> ▲ **A3-08 (Major):** Remove Integrations Lead, Customer Success Lead, Learning Design Lead (red rows); add Product Manager (Lucas Bennett) and People & Culture Lead (Hannah Brooks).

Table 2. Business and IT governance roles

Role	Name (Fictional)	Responsibilities
Board Chair (Independent Director)	Dr Margaret Ellison	• Leads the Board, sets its agenda and evaluates the CEO • Provides independent higher-education expertise • Ensures directors meet their duties under the Corporations Act
Investor Director	James Whitford	• Represents seed investors on the Board • Oversees budget, cash runway and fundraising • Co-approves major capital and risk decisions

Role	Name (Fictional)	Responsibilities
Chief Executive Officer (CEO) & Co-founder	Priya Raman	• Sets company strategy and FY2027 objectives • Leads the executive team and chairs the Technology & Risk Committee • Owns relationships with university executives (DVC level) • Accountable to the Board for company performance
Chief Technology Officer (CTO) & Co-founder	Daniel Park	• Owns technical architecture, platform reliability and engineering delivery • Holds CIO accountabilities for internal IT • Manages AWS and model-provider vendor relationships • Presents IT investment cases to the Technology & Risk Committee
Head of Product & Learning Design	Dr Sarah Nguyen	• Owns the product roadmap and quarterly squad priorities • Leads pedagogical co-design with universities • Turns Academic Advisory Board advice into product decisions
Head of Growth (Sales & Customer Success)	Tom Gallagher	• Leads enterprise sales, paid pilots and pilot-to-licence conversion • Leads onboarding, customer success and quarterly business reviews (QBRs) • Owns revenue and renewal targets
Head of Trust & Compliance	Aisha Karim	• Privacy Officer and ISO 27001 information security lead • Manages Privacy Act, PPIP Act and WCAG 2.2 compliance • Completes university security and procurement assessments • Reports risk to the Technology & Risk Committee
Head of Finance & People	Rebecca Lim	• Manages budget, cash flow, pricing models and gross-margin reporting • Leads HR, recruitment, contracts and payroll • Company secretary
Engineering Manager – Platform	Marcus O'Brien	• Leads platform engineers and AWS Sydney infrastructure • Runs DevOps, release management and incident response

Role	Name (Fictional)	Responsibilities
ML & Retrieval Lead	Dr Wei Zhang	• Leads the retrieval-augmented generation pipeline and citation accuracy • Owns the evaluation harness and grounding-quality metrics • Controls inference cost through caching and model routing
Integrations Lead	Hannah Brooks	• Builds LTI 1.3 / LTI Advantage integrations with Canvas, Moodle and Blackboard • Manages single sign-on and 1EdTech certification
Customer Success Lead	Liam Fraser	• Onboards faculties and academics • Prepares QBR usage reports • Feeds customer feedback to the product team
Learning Design Lead	Grace Mitchell	• Builds prompt and question templates aligned to unit learning outcomes • Runs academic training and co-design workshops
Academic Advisory Board Chair (external)	Prof. Alan Mercer	• Gives independent advice on pedagogy and AI in assessment • Advises on research ethics for learning-impact studies

Core Business Challenge or Opportunity

Business Challenge or Opportunity

> ▲ **A3-01 (Critical):** Team anchor is Project ATLAS. The challenge is a ~44% gross margin (target 70%) from inference cost, and answer quality not measured continuously.
>
> ▲ **A3-09 (Critical):** Rewrite with team figures: 1 licence + 4 pilots; ~16,500 students; ~740,000 questions/month; AUD 0.053 per question; AUD 8.94 per EFTSL; 3 outages. Remove '9 pilots / 2 converted' and '2-day QBR'.

Lyra's core challenge is **proving learning impact so that paid faculty pilots convert into campus-wide licences and then renew**. Lyra's revenue model is land-and-expand: a faculty pilot should grow into a university-wide EFTSL licence (*About the Organisation*). In its first year Lyra ran nine faculty pilots at six universities, but only two have converted (Lyra internal sales data, 2026). Reaching eight licences in FY2027 requires a much higher conversion rate.

The barrier is evidence. A Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Education) must justify a licence to a procurement committee with evidence of better student outcomes, yet Lyra's pilot reports only show usage: logins, questions asked and citations opened.

Customer success staff also build every QBR by hand from spreadsheets and application logs, which takes about two days per report.

The problem touches several BMC blocks: **Revenue Streams** (slower land-and-expand), **Customer Relationships** (QBRs report activity rather than value), **Value Proposition** (the promised visibility for academics is thin) and **Cost Structure** (scarce staff time spent on manual reporting). It is also an **opportunity**: the analytics dashboard is already listed as a premium module, so solving the evidence gap can create new revenue, not only remove a cost.

Root Cause Analysis

> ▲ **A3-10 (Critical):** Methods can stay (add SWOT). Rewrite the 5 Whys and redraw the fishbone for the margin gap; root cause = no continuous measurement or control layer.

Two methods were combined. The **5 Whys** follows one chain of cause and effect to its source (Ohno, 1988), while a **fishbone diagram** checks for causes across several categories so that nothing is missed (Ishikawa, 1990).

Table 3. 5 Whys analysis

Why?	Answer
1. Why do pilots convert slowly?	University executives lack evidence that Lyra improves learning outcomes.
2. Why is there no evidence?	Pilot reports show usage, not outcomes such as assessment results or progression.
3. Why only usage?	Lyra's data stops at its own app: it receives no LMS activity or grades, and reports are compiled by hand.
4. Why is there no LMS data link?	The roadmap focused on the retrieval core; LTI Advantage grade services and data-sharing agreements were never prioritised.
5. Why was it never prioritised?	Evidence was treated as a sales task, not a product capability, so no executive owns it.
Root cause	**Learning-impact measurement is not designed into Lyra's product or governance.**

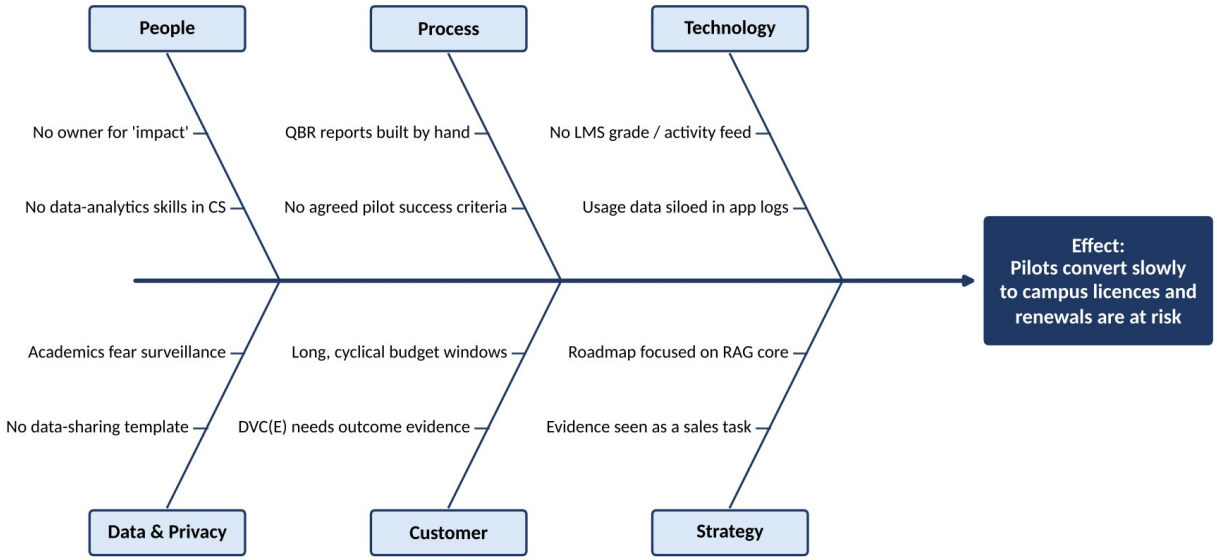


Figure 2. Fishbone diagram – causes of slow pilot-to-licence conversion

The fishbone supports the 5 Whys result and adds two contributing causes: academics' fear that analytics means surveillance, and the lack of a standard data-sharing agreement. Any solution must address both, because universities will not release the data needed to measure impact without them.

Draft IT-Enabled Proposal

Proposed IT initiative (High level idea)

> ▲ **A3-11 (Critical):** Replace Impact Hub with Project ATLAS (gateway, adaptive router, caching, continuous evaluation and tracing, FinOps and tenant insight). My cost-to-serve and QBR ideas fit inside ATLAS component 5.

We propose **Lyra Impact Hub**, a privacy-preserving learning-analytics module that measures and reports Lyra's effect on learning automatically. It has four components:

1. **Data connectors** – LTI Advantage grade services and Caliper activity events bring LMS activity and assessment results into Lyra under a standard data-sharing agreement (1EdTech Consortium, 2019). Data is de-identified on arrival and stays in AWS Sydney.
2. **Impact analytics engine** – compares matched groups of users and non-users with similar prior results, and groups students' questions into 'struggle topics' for each unit.
3. **Insight reports** – an upgraded educator dashboard plus automatically generated pilot evaluations and QBR reports. A large language model writes

plain-English summaries that cite the underlying figures, keeping Lyra's principle that every answer cites its source.

4. **Cost-to-serve view** – inference spend per EFTSL for each licence, for internal margin management.

Privacy-by-design rules apply throughout: results are shown only for groups of at least ten students, individual staff or students are never ranked, and students can opt out. This mirrors good practice in learning analytics, where value depends on trust in how data is used (Siemens & Long, 2011).

The Hub creates value by turning evidence into a product capability, which removes the root cause above. University executives gain a defensible business case, academics see where students struggle, and customer success staff spend their time advising rather than compiling spreadsheets.

Business Value Proposition

> ▲ **A3-12 (Critical):** Keep the alignment framing. Replace the table with the team BMC figures (AUD 8.94 to 2.52 per EFTSL; margin 44% to ~72%; ~AUD 1.5M a year).

In the business–IT alignment model, the Hub is an IT investment that builds a new IT capability (learning analytics) to strengthen a business capability (evidence-based customer success), creating organisational value for universities, academics, students and Lyra (The University of Sydney, 2026). Table 4 links each benefit to the BMC and to Lyra's FY2027 objectives.

Table 4. Benefits mapped to the Business Model Canvas and strategic objectives

Benefit	BMC block improved	FY2027 objective supported
Outcome evidence for every pilot shortens the path to a campus licence	Revenue Streams; Customer Relationships	Eight university-wide licences
QBRs show learning impact, not only usage	Customer Relationships	90% renewal
Struggle-topic insights help academics adjust teaching	Value Proposition (academics)	90% renewal; differentiation
Analytics sold as a premium module	Revenue Streams	Gross margin above 70%
QBR preparation falls from about two days to under two hours	Key Activities; Cost Structure	Gross margin above 70%
Inference cost visible per licence	Cost Structure	Gross margin above 70%
A growing, de-identified impact dataset becomes intellectual property	Key Resources	Long-term competitive advantage

The Hub also widens the market gap identified in *About the Organisation*. Consumer AI tools cannot provide institution-level evidence, and the generic analytics of LMS incumbents are not linked to curriculum-grounded study activity. Evidence of impact therefore becomes a competitive advantage that is hard to copy.

Preliminary Constraints

> ▲ **A3-13 (Major):** Budget/timeline: ~9 FTE for six months; 2 Nov 2026 – 30 Apr 2027; gateway live before Semester 1 2027; AUD 1.41M (AUD 0.46M new cash).
>
> ▲ **A3-14 (Major):** Replace other rows with quality risk, automated-decision transparency (10 Dec 2026), LLMOps/FinOps skills and vendor dependency; drop NHMRC, integration variability, self-selection bias and the analyst hire.

> ▲ **A3-15 (Minor):** Add a closing sentence linking the constraints to AW4–AW11.

Table 5. Preliminary constraints and initial responses

Constraint	Description	Initial response
Budget	Seed funding is limited. One squad of about five people for five months competes with the core retrieval roadmap.	Build a minimum viable Hub first; sell analytics as a premium module. Estimate in AW6.
Timeline	Universities set budgets once a year, so evidence must exist before the mid-2027 renewal cycle.	Build over summer and pilot in Semester 1 2027.
Data access and privacy	Each university must approve data sharing under the Privacy Act 1988 (Cth) and, in NSW, the PPIP Act 1998. Publishing impact research may need ethics approval (National Health and Medical Research Council [NHMRC], 2023).	Standard data-sharing agreement and privacy impact assessment; de-identify at ingestion.
Resistance	Academics may see analytics as surveillance; customer success staff are used to manual reports; engineers may resist leaving the core roadmap.	Opt-in, aggregate-only design and a change management plan (AW8).
Skills	Lyra lacks data-engineering and evaluation-design expertise.	Hire one data analyst; train existing staff.
Integration	Canvas, Moodle and Blackboard implement LTI Advantage differently.	Start with Canvas, which most pilot universities use.
Evidence validity	Students who use Lyra may already be more motivated (self-selection bias).	Report results as associations with clear limits; review the method with the Academic Advisory Board.

References

> ▲ **A3-16 (Minor):** Rebuild after the rewrite: add the team's ATLAS sources; remove NHMRC, Siemens & Long and 1EdTech if no longer cited.

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Weill, P., & Ross, J. W. (2004). *IT governance: How top performers manage IT decision rights for superior results*. Harvard Business School Press.

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Change Management Plan

Alignment check of my AW8 – Change Management Plan against the team anchor (Project ATLAS). IDs match 'AW3 & AW8 - Alignment review (changes needed).pdf'.

Red conflicts with the team's story or facts – rewrite or remove

Yellow right idea, but names, numbers, owners or wording must change

No highlight consistent with the team version – can stay

Introduction

▲ **A8-01 (Critical):** Re-anchor on Project ATLAS: engineers adopt evaluation gates and the gateway; learning designers become evaluators; Customer Success explains cost and quality; academics trust a smaller model.

▲ **A8-02 (Minor):** Models are the same as the team. Cite Kotter (2012); link to AW4, AW5, AW7 and make change readiness a Gate 3 criterion.

▲ **A8-03 (Critical):** Roadmap must follow AW4: Gate 0 12 Nov, Gate 1 4 Dec, Gate 2 29 Jan, Release 1 10 Feb, Release 2 25 Mar, Gate 4 30 Apr, review 30 Jul 2027. Owners per AW7.

Change management (CM) is the structured approach to moving individuals, teams and the organisation from a current state to a desired future state. It focuses on how people adopt a change, not on building the technology itself (The University of Sydney, 2026). Project management asks *"Is the system built and working?"*; change management asks *"Are people actually using it?"*. Its purpose is to make sure an IT investment delivers its benefits, and projects with excellent CM are reported to be six times more likely to meet their objectives (The University of Sydney, 2026).

This plan supports **Lyra Impact Hub**, proposed in *Governance & Proposal*. The Hub links LMS activity and assessment data with Lyra usage to produce automated learning-impact evidence, educator insights and quarterly business review (QBR) reports. The build is modest; the harder change is behavioural. Customer success staff must stop hand-building reports, engineers must own a new data product, academics must trust and act on analytics, and university privacy and IT teams must approve new data flows.

The plan combines **Kotter's 8-step model** (Kotter, 1996) to build organisation-wide momentum with **ADKAR** (Hiatt, 2006) to move each person from awareness to reinforcement. Table 1 shows how both are sequenced across the project and who owns each phase.

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Table 1. Change roadmap

Phase and timing	Kotter steps	ADKAR focus	Key change actions	Owner
1. Prepare Nov–Dec 2026	1 Urgency, 2 Coalition, 3 Vision	Awareness	Share conversion data (2 of 9 pilots); form change team and champions; agree vision	CEO (sponsor)
2. Engage Jan–Feb 2027	4 Communicate, 5 Remove barriers	Desire, Knowledge	Launch communications; co-design reports; standard data-sharing agreement; training	Head of Growth (change owner)
3. Pilot Semester 1 2027	6 Short-term wins	Ability	Hub live at two early-adopter universities; coaching; first evidence-based QBR	Customer Success Lead
4. Scale and embed Jul–Dec 2027	7 Consolidate, 8 Anchor in culture	Reinforcement	Roll out to all customers; retire manual QBR template; add impact KPIs to every squad	Head of Growth and CEO

Change vision and objectives

▲ **A8-04 (Critical):** Use the team vision: 'Every answer Lyra gives is one we can stand behind, and every dollar we spend producing it is one we can account for...' (AW12 quotes it).

▲ **A8-05 (Critical):** Replace objectives with the team's five (≥90% understanding by Gate 2; 100% gates and gateway from R1; certified on-call; security reviews before R1; sustained by Jul 2027).

> ***Vision:*** *Every Lyra conversation with a university is backed by trustworthy evidence of learning impact – so academics know where students struggle, universities invest with confidence, and our team spends its time improving learning rather than compiling spreadsheets.*

The vision links directly to Lyra's mission of making course materials genuinely navigable: evidence shows whether that mission is being achieved. It is deliberately short so that every staff member can repeat it, which is Kotter's test of a clear vision (Kotter, 1996).

The change management process has five objectives. Each has a target that is measured in the final section of this plan.

Table 2. Change management objectives

Objective	Target
O1 Awareness and buy-in	All Lyra staff can explain why the Hub matters (pulse survey average of 4 out of 5 or higher) by February 2027
O2 Internal adoption	100% of QBRs and pilot evaluations produced through the Hub, and manual spreadsheet reports retired, by September 2027

Objective	Target
O3 Academic adoption	60% of unit coordinators in licensed units use the dashboard at least fortnightly during semester by the end of 2027
O4 Trust and compliance	Data-sharing agreements signed with every pilot university before go-live, with zero privacy incidents
O5 Business outcome	Pilot-to-licence conversion rises from 22% (2 of 9) to at least 50% of 2027 pilots, supporting eight licences and 90% renewal

Change drivers and impact analysis

> ▲ **A8-06 (Major):** Financial sustainability is the primary driver (44% margin; AUD 0.053/question). Add resilience (3 outages), technology opportunity and automated-decision transparency; drop pilot and QBR figures.
>
> ▲ **A8-07 (Major):** Replace the impact table with ATLAS impacts and add a fifth row: Customers (universities).

Five drivers make this change necessary now:

- **Competitive advantage** – only two of nine pilots have converted, and LMS incumbents are adding generic AI analytics. Proven impact is what differentiates Lyra.
- **Customer demand** – university executives need outcome evidence to justify spending, especially given sector scrutiny of generative AI (Lodge et al., 2023).
- **Efficiency improvement** – each QBR takes about two days of scarce customer success time.
- **Regulatory compliance** – the *Privacy Act 1988* (Cth) and the NSW *PPIP Act 1998* require student data to be handled lawfully and transparently, which ad-hoc spreadsheet exports cannot guarantee.
- **Financial** – a gross margin above 70% needs visibility of inference cost per licence.

Table 3. Impact analysis

Area	Current state	Future state	Impact
Processes	QBRs built by hand; pilot success criteria agreed informally	Reports generated automatically; success measures agreed at pilot kick-off; data-sharing agreement in every contract	High
Technology	Usage data sits in app logs and spreadsheets	LMS data connectors, a de-identified analytics store and an upgraded educator dashboard	Medium

Area	Current state	Future state	Impact
People	Customer success staff compile reports; few academics use the dashboard	Customer success staff act as evidence-based advisers; academics act on struggle-topic insights; new data analyst role	High
Culture	Evaluation data used only for model quality; impact seen as a sales job	Every squad shares ownership of customer learning outcomes	Medium–High

Stakeholder analysis

> ▲ **A8-08 (Major):** Keep 'academics and university security are top priority' (matches AW5). Re-segment groups, fix headcounts (engineering 18; 2 learning designers) and add an ADKAR-barrier column.

Stakeholders were identified from Lyra's organisation chart and the customer segments in the Business Model Canvas. Table 4 maps the impact on each group, its influence over success, its expected resistance and the engagement strategy. The highest priority groups are those with high impact and high resistance – **academics** and **university IT and privacy officers** – because without their agreement no data flows and the Hub has nothing to measure.

Table 4. Change impact map

Stakeholder	Impact of the change	Influence	Resistance	Engagement strategy
Board and executive team	Fund and sponsor the change; little change to daily work	High	Low	Monthly progress through the Technology & Risk Committee; visible sponsorship by the CEO
Customer success and sales (5)	New reporting workflow and new analytical skills	High	Medium	Co-design report templates; change champion in the team; early hands-on training
Engineering (16)	Build and run a new data pipeline	High	Medium	CTO frames the Hub as a core product capability; dedicated squad; recognised in objectives
Learning designers (5)	Turn struggle topics into teaching advice	Medium	Low	Involve as co-designers of insight wording
Academics and unit coordinators	New dashboard and insights in their teaching	High	High	Opt-in by unit; aggregate-only data; Academic Advisory Board endorsement; 15-minute onboarding
DVC (Education) and teaching and learning centres	Receive evidence reports for licence decisions	High	Low	Agree success measures at pilot kick-off; review results in QBRs

Stakeholder	Impact of the change	Influence	Resistance	Engagement strategy
University IT and privacy officers	Approve data flows and configure LTI Advantage	High	Medium–High	Pre-completed privacy impact assessment; standard data-sharing agreement; integration team support
Students	Their data is used in aggregate; option to opt out	Medium	Low–Medium	Clear in-app privacy notice; consult student association

Communication plan

> ▲ **A8-09 (Major):** Owners per team (CEO and CTO, Applied AI Lead, Engineering Manager, CPO, Head of Customer Success, Product Owner, Head of Security). Use #atlas and Notion change hub; add the 30-day university change notice.

Communication follows two principles from the lecture: explain the *why*, not just the *what*, and keep channels two-way so concerns surface early (The University of Sydney, 2026). Messages are tailored to each group in Table 5, and every channel includes a way to reply, such as Q&A sessions, a Slack channel or an in-product feedback button.

Table 5. Communication plan

Stakeholder	Objective	Methods	Frequency	Owner
Board and executive	Keep sponsorship; track benefits	Committee report; board paper	Monthly; quarterly	CEO
All Lyra staff	Awareness of why and progress	CEO all-hands launch; #impact-hub Slack channel; demo days	Launch, then fortnightly	CEO
Customer success and sales	Desire and knowledge of the new workflow	Co-design workshops; stand-up check-ins; playbook	Weekly during pilot	Customer Success Lead
Engineering	Clear scope and ownership	Sprint reviews; architecture decision records	Fortnightly	CTO
Academics	Build trust; explain what data is and is not used	Two-minute video; FAQ; LMS announcement; faculty briefing; in-product tips	Semester start and mid-semester	Learning Design Lead with university T&L centre
DVC (Education) and T&L centres	Agree success measures; show results	Pilot kick-off workshop; QBR impact report	Kick-off, then quarterly	Head of Growth
University IT and privacy	Approve data flows	Privacy impact assessment pack; technical briefing	Before pilot, then as needed	Head of Trust & Compliance

Stakeholder	Objective	Methods	Frequency	Owner
Students	Transparency and choice	In-app privacy notice; help-centre article	First use each semester	Head of Trust & Compliance

Training and capacity Building

▲ **A8-10 (Major):** Replace needs with ATLAS training (game days, gate workshop, κ ≥ 0.7 calibration, claims certification); budget AUD 9,000 (AW6). Remove analyst hire. Kirkpatrick can stay.

Training builds the *Knowledge* and *Ability* stages of ADKAR. Each group's needs were identified from the impact analysis, and delivery is kept short and practical because both Lyra staff and academics are time-poor.

Table 6. Training needs, delivery and support

Group	Training need	Delivery method	Support system
Customer success and sales	Reading impact reports, explaining their limits (association is not causation), running evidence-based QBRs	Two hands-on workshops using real pilot data; QBR role-plays	Playbook; champion buddy; weekly check-in
Engineering	Data pipeline, de-identification, LTI Advantage grade services	Internal tech talks; pair programming	Runbooks; architecture documents
Learning designers	Turning struggle topics into teaching recommendations	Co-design sessions	Template library
Academics	Reading the dashboard, acting on insights, privacy guardrails	Two-minute video; 15-minute faculty briefing; in-product walkthrough	Help centre; customer success contact; drop-in office hours
University IT staff	Configuring LTI Advantage and data flows	Technical onboarding session and documentation	Integration team support channel

Capacity building. Lyra will hire one data analyst to close the skills gap identified in AW3, and train one change champion in each team. Champions are respected peers who answer questions and pass on feedback; this change agent network speeds adoption through peer influence (The University of Sydney, 2026).

Measurement. Training is evaluated with Kirkpatrick's four levels (Kirkpatrick & Kirkpatrick, 2016): *Reaction* (post-session rating of 4 out of 5 or higher), *Learning* (a short quiz and a QBR role-play assessed by the Customer Success Lead), *Behaviour* (share of reports produced through the Hub and dashboard use by academics) and *Results* (pilot conversion and renewal).

Resistance Management

> ▲ **A8-11 (Major):** Use the team's sources (autonomy, 'cheap AI' fear, workload, competence anxiety, selling point, motives, procedural caution). Keep Kübler-Ross/Rogers reworded. Escalate via AW7 (Project Board L2, Steering Committee L3).

Resistance is the norm rather than the exception (The University of Sydney, 2026), so it is planned for rather than treated as failure. Table 7 lists the main sources of resistance, the psychological response behind each, and the strategy to address it.

Table 7. Sources of resistance and strategies

Source	Who	Psychological response	Strategy
Fear of surveillance and loss of academic autonomy	Academics, students	Fear of the unknown	Aggregate-only results (10 or more students); no ranking of staff or students; opt-in by unit; publish a plain-English 'what we collect' page; Academic Advisory Board endorsement
Loss of craft and fear of automation	Customer success staff	Loss aversion	Co-design the templates; keep an editable narrative section; frame the Hub as freeing time for advice; commit that no roles will be cut
Competing priorities	Engineers	Status quo bias	Dedicated squad; CTO sponsorship; Hub work counted in team objectives; show the link to company targets
Workload and risk aversion	University IT and privacy officers	Status quo bias	Pre-completed privacy impact assessment; standard agreement; Lyra's integration team does the configuration
Doubt about the evidence	Academics, DVC (Education)	Cognitive dissonance	Transparent method with stated limits; independent review by the Academic Advisory Board
Change fatigue	Time-poor academics	Fear of extra workload	Launch at semester start, never mid-assessment; onboarding kept to 15 minutes

Three further tactics support these strategies. First, the **Kübler-Ross change curve** predicts a dip in morale and productivity during the pilot (e.g., "our spreadsheets work fine"), so coaching and support are front-loaded in Phase 3 and early wins are shared to rebuild confidence. Second, **Diffusion of Innovation** theory (Rogers, 2003) guides the rollout: the pilot starts with early-adopter faculties, their results are used as social proof for the majority, and laggards receive one-to-one support. Third, sceptical people with high influence, such as a senior academic, are identified early and invited into co-design so that critics become contributors.

Resistance issues are recorded in a change log reviewed fortnightly by the Head of Growth. Any issue unresolved after two reviews is escalated to the Technology & Risk Committee.

Cultural Considerations

Company Culture before the change

> ▲ **A8-12 (Minor):** Same diagnosis as the team. Reword the last paragraph: evidence is used offline and occasionally (optionally cite Schein, 2010).

The Competing Values Framework identifies four culture types (Cameron & Quinn, 2011): **Clan** (collaborative, family-like), **Adhocracy** (innovative, experimental, risk-taking), **Market** (competitive, focused on results and customers) and **Hierarchy** (controlled, process-driven).

Lyra's current culture is mainly an **Adhocracy** with **Clan** features. *About the Organisation* describes a company that is deliberately small and cross-functional, where engineers, learning designers and former academics share squads. The flat structure, rapid experimentation and engineering-led product decisions are typical of an adhocracy, while the small team and shared squads give it a collaborative, clan-like feel. Lyra also has a strong evidence habit, because product claims are settled by evaluation data rather than enthusiasm.

However, that evidence habit points **inwards**, at model quality, rather than **outwards**, at customer outcomes. Success is measured by shipping features, and proving value to universities is treated as the sales team's job. This is the cultural root of the challenge identified in AW3.

Desired company culture after the change

> ▲ **A8-13 (Major):** Rename to 'disciplined adhocracy': add selected Hierarchy practices (gates, CAB) and measure Market results by cost per question and margin, not licences.

The target is an **Adhocracy–Market blend**, which we call *evidence-led innovation*. Lyra keeps its innovative, experimental strengths but adopts the Market quadrant's external focus on results: every squad sees impact metrics, and success means measurable outcomes for universities and students, not features shipped.

This blend is justified for three reasons. First, Lyra's FY2027 objectives (eight licences, 90% renewal and a 70% margin) are market measures, so the culture should value what the strategy measures. Second, university customers buy on evidence, so outcome focus is directly linked to revenue. Third, competition from LMS incumbents means Lyra must prove a difference rather than claim one.

The Clan values of trust and privacy must be kept. A purely Market culture could create pressure to overstate impact, which would damage the trust Lyra depends on. The rule is therefore simple: **we only claim what the data supports**.

Bridging the gap

> ▲ **A8-14 (Major):** 7S format can stay, but use the team's actions: CTO/Applied AI Lead lead by example, automated CI gates, rewards via People & Culture Lead, 'cost and quality minute', update AI Policy.

McKinsey's 7S model is used to align the elements that shape culture, with shared values at the centre (The University of Sydney, 2026).

Table 8. Bridging actions using the McKinsey 7S model

7S element	Bridging action
Shared values	Add "We prove our impact – honestly" to Lyra's company values, next to privacy
Strategy and systems	Put one impact KPI in every squad's quarterly objectives and on the team dashboard
Style	The CEO opens each all-hands meeting with a customer impact result, modelling the new focus
Structure	The Head of Growth is accountable for impact; each engineer attends one QBR per quarter
Staff and skills	Hire a data analyst and deliver the training in Table 6
Recognition	Celebrate the first renewal won with Hub evidence (Kotter step 8: anchor the change)

Success metrics and monitoring

> ▲ **A8-15 (Critical):** Replace KPIs with the team's (AW12 lists them by name): awareness ≥90% by Gate 2, training before R1, game-day certification, gateway routing, gate coverage, κ ≥ 0.7, security reviews, answer flags, ≥75% 'better or easier'.

> ▲ **A8-16 (Major):** Use AW12 per-KPI thresholds; keep ITIL 4 (matches AW12); owner Delivery Lead / Steering Committee; add 'you said, we did'.

Adoption is measured with a balanced set of **leading** KPIs, which give early warning while the change is happening, and **lagging** KPIs, which confirm that the business benefit was realised. Each KPI in Table 9 maps to an objective from Table 2 and has a baseline, target, data source, frequency and owner.

Table 9. Change adoption KPIs

KPI (objective)	Type	Baseline	Target	Data source	Frequency	Owner
ADKAR pulse score (O1)	Leading	New	4.0 / 5 or higher	Staff pulse survey	Monthly	Head of Finance & People

KPI (objective)	Type	Baseline	Target	Data source	Frequency	Owner
Training completion (O1)	Leading	0%	100% of staff; 80% of pilot coordinators	HR and LMS records	Fortnightly	Learning Design Lead
Data-sharing agreements signed (O4)	Leading	0	Every pilot university before go-live	Contract register	Monthly	Head of Trust & Compliance
Reports produced through the Hub (O2)	Leading	0%	100% by Sep 2027	Hub audit log	Monthly	Customer Success Lead
QBR preparation time (O2)	Lagging	~2 days	Under 2 hours	Time logs	Quarterly	Customer Success Lead
Coordinators using dashboard fortnightly (O3)	Leading	~15%	60%	Product analytics	Weekly in semester	Head of Product
Academics who trust Lyra's data use (O3)	Leading	Pilot-start survey	75% agree	Academic survey	Each semester	Head of Trust & Compliance
Privacy incidents (O4)	Guardrail	0	0	Incident register	Monthly	Head of Trust & Compliance
Pilot-to-licence conversion (O5)	Lagging	22%	50% or higher	CRM	Quarterly	Head of Growth
Licence renewal rate (O5)	Lagging	No renewals yet	90%	CRM	Quarterly	CEO

Escalation threshold. If any leading KPI is more than 20% below target for two consecutive months, the Head of Growth escalates it to the Technology & Risk Committee with a recovery plan.

Feedback mechanisms. Five channels collect feedback:

- an in-product feedback button and one-question survey for academics;
- a fortnightly change champion meeting to surface issues from each team;
- the monthly ADKAR pulse survey, which shows *which* stage is the barrier – for example, low Ability scores trigger extra coaching rather than more communication;
- end-of-semester retrospectives with each pilot university; and
- a review of support-ticket themes and Academic Advisory Board advice each quarter.

Continuous improvement. Results feed the ITIL 4 continual improvement model (AXELOS, 2019), which asks: What is the vision? Where are we now? Where do we want to be? How do we get there? Take action. Did we get there? How do we keep the momentum going? In practice this is a monthly cycle: collect KPI and feedback

data, diagnose the gap using ADKAR, agree an improvement action with an owner, and re-measure the next month. Actions are tracked in a continual improvement register owned by the Head of Growth. Once all targets have been met for two consecutive quarters, the KPIs move into Lyra's normal business reporting, which signals that the change has become *the way we do things* (Kotter, 1996). Benefit tracking then continues under the monitoring framework in AW12.

References

> ▲ **A8-17 (Minor):** Kotter (2012) not 1996; add NAIC (2025) and Schein (2010) if used; keep AXELOS, Kirkpatrick and Rogers only if the text keeps them.

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